Questions You Should Ask

You're not only being auditioned — you're the one deciding too. Asking honest questions is the most impressive thing in the room. Pick three or four; bringing all of them is the only wrong move.

ABOUT THE WORK ITSELF

- [ ] What does a normal day look like from where you sit?
- [ ] What would you want done in my first month that nobody will be sad wasn't done sooner?
- [ ] How much of this job is the part in the posting, and how much is the part that never gets posted?

ABOUT THE TEAM

- [ ] What's the best thing about this team right now?
- [ ] Who did the last person in this role help the most?
- [ ] How do people like to be reached when something's urgent?

ABOUT SUCCESS

- [ ] A year from now, what will make you say this hire worked?
- [ ] How does anyone here find out they're doing well?
- [ ] What do people usually wish they'd known sooner?

PRACTICAL, AND IT'S FINE TO ASK

- [ ] What are the next steps, and about when?
- [ ] Is there anything I can send to make your decision easier?
- [ ] Could I meet a couple of people I'd work with day to day?

MY OWN — WRITE THEM WHILE THEY HAPPEN

> Best sign in the room: somewhere around question two, the chat turns into two people figuring out one job. If it does, you did it right — regardless of anything else today.

Skip questions the posting already answers. The above are open-ended on purpose; they invite a story, and stories tell you more than facts ever will.